

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	6 — The Age of Reorganisation
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. The Maurya empire broke up from within rather than being destroyed by foreign invaders; the foreign rulers were largely absorbed into a dominant Indian culture rather than erasing it; a matrimonial alliance was an act of diplomatic integration; the Gandhara school is Greco-Buddhist while Mathura is the indigenous red-sandstone school; and royal women of the age could wield real power. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A historian argues that the very label 'Age of Reorganisation' is more accurate than calling these centuries an 'age of decline'. The strongest reason to prefer 'reorganisation' is that the period:

- (A) produced no rulers, monuments or trade worth recording
- (B) saw old territories repeatedly reshaped into many new kingdoms while art, trade and learning flourished
- (C) was a single empire merely reorganising its provinces
- (D) ended all warfare and replaced it with peaceful unity

2. Suppose a student claims the Maurya Empire was 'smashed by a foreign invasion from the northwest'. The chapter's evidence best corrects this by showing that:

- (A) the Kushanas conquered the whole Mauryan heartland in a single campaign
- (B) the Indo-Greeks ruled jointly with the Mauryas until the empire ended
- (C) the Satavahanas marched north and destroyed the Mauryan capital
- (D) the empire fell apart from internal causes, and only afterwards did foreign rulers move into the weakened northwest

3. The order 'first the Mauryas weaken from within, then invaders enter the northwest' matters because it lets a historian conclude that:

- (A) the foreign invasions were the original cause of the Mauryan collapse
- (B) internal weakness was the cause and the foreign entry was a later effect of it
- (C) the Mauryas and the invaders were two names for the same rulers
- (D) the northwest had never been part of the Mauryan realm

4. Pushyamitra, who founded the Shunga line, rose to power by:

- (A) killing the last Maurya ruler while serving as the army's commander, then taking the throne himself
- (B) winning a popular election among the Mauryan nobles
- (C) marrying the last Mauryan emperor's daughter and inheriting the realm
- (D) leading a foreign army that besieged the Mauryan capital

5. Which one-sentence summary best matches the chapter's overall portrait of these centuries?

- (A) a calm, war-free age in which only peaceful trade occurred
- (B) fierce political competition among many kingdoms went together with rich cultural blending
- (C) a cultural dark age in which nothing of value was created
- (D) an era in which every kingdom was governed by foreign invaders

6. Two kingdoms long at war suddenly become firm partners after the daughter of one king weds the prince of the other. A historian reading this would most reasonably treat the marriage as:

- (A) a piece of diplomacy that turned rivalry into alliance
- (B) a private wedding with no bearing on relations between the two states
- (C) a religious sacrifice performed to win the favour of the gods
- (D) a means by which one kingdom collected yearly tribute from the other

7. A ruler releases a horse to wander for a year, follows it with his army, and then performs a great sacrifice. The best explanation of his purpose is that he wishes to:

- (A) assert supreme kingship by claiming every land the unchallenged horse crossed
- (B) select his successor by the path the horse happened to take
- (C) seal a marriage alliance with a neighbouring dynasty
- (D) fix the starting point of a new dated calendar era

8. An inscription records that a widowed Satavahana queen herself carried out an ashvamedha. The soundest inference is that:

- (A) royal women of this age could exercise genuine political and ritual authority
- (B) the sacrifice had by then lost any link to claiming kingship
- (C) only men ever held real power in these kingdoms
- (D) the Satavahanas had abandoned all Vedic ritual

9. Which pairing best matches a dynasty with its most characteristic act in the chapter?

- (A) the Shungas — building the Grand Anicut across the Kaveri
- (B) the Shungas — controlling the overland Silk Route
- (C) the Shungas — minting coins that carried Greek royal portraits
- (D) the Shungas — reviving Vedic ritual and adorning the Bharhut Stupa

10. It seems odd that the Vedic-reviving Shungas patronised the Buddhist Bharhut Stupa. The best reading of this is that:

- (A) the Shungas had secretly converted to Buddhism
- (B) favouring one tradition did not stop rulers of the age from sponsoring fine art for another
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa was in fact a Vedic temple, not a Buddhist site
- (D) Buddhism had completely disappeared by Shunga times

11. If a reference work defines 'stupa' simply as 'a tall stone victory pillar', a reader of this chapter should correct it to:

- (A) a free-standing Greek-style victory column
- (B) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, often surrounded by carved railings and reliefs
- (C) a low dam built to divert a river into canals
- (D) an anthology of early Tamil poems

12. On a map of this age, the Shungas and the Satavahanas would be shaded in two different regions, respectively:

- (A) the Tamil far south for the Shungas and Kalinga for the Satavahanas
- (B) north-central India for the Shungas and the Deccan plateau for the Satavahanas
- (C) the northwest frontier for the Shungas and the Tamil south for the Satavahanas
- (D) the Deccan for the Shungas and north-central India for the Satavahanas

13. A Satavahana coin stamped with a two-masted ship is best used as evidence that the dynasty:

- (A) worshipped the sea as a deity
- (B) had lost all of its land territory
- (C) built a navy specifically to fight the Kushanas
- (D) carried on a thriving maritime trade

14. A king of this age is called 'Gautamiputra', and inscriptions also record his mother Gautami Balashri donating land. Taken together, these facts most strongly indicate that:

- (A) kings were always named after the chief god they worshipped
- (B) 'Gautami' was the dynasty's original founding city
- (C) the king had taken vows as a Buddhist monk
- (D) royal women held enough standing that kings were even identified by their mothers' names

15. We know about Satavahana queens such as Gautami Balashri chiefly because they:

- (A) led armies into battle against the Roman Empire
- (B) composed the Tamil Sangam poems
- (C) made donations that were recorded in inscriptions
- (D) created the Gandhara school of sculpture

16. The Satavahanas' trade reaching as far as the Roman world is best explained by their:

- (A) sharing a land frontier directly with the Roman Empire
- (B) command of the overland Silk Route through Central Asia
- (C) status as a tribute-paying province of Rome
- (D) control of Deccan ports and the western sea routes

17. Kharavela, the 'monk-king' of this chapter, is best described as a ruler who:

- (A) governed Kalinga as king while himself being a devout follower of Jainism
- (B) gave up his throne to wander as a homeless monk
- (C) was a Kushana governor of Gandhara in the northwest
- (D) founded an entirely new monastic religion of his own

18. Almost everything known about Kharavela comes from the Hathigumpha inscription. This dependence best illustrates that, for this age, historians rely heavily on:

- (A) Tamil Sangam poems composed in honour of northern kings
- (B) Roman trade ledgers that named Indian rulers
- (C) coins struck with each ruler's portrait
- (D) writing carved into lasting material to recover a ruler's deeds

19. Which list names ONLY the three crowned Tamil kingdoms of the southern country?

- (A) Shungas, Satavahanas and Chedis (B) Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas
- (C) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas (D) Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas

20. Why does the term 'Sangam Age' attach to the early history of the Tamil south?

- (A) because a famous series of battles among southern kings bore that name
- (B) because an assembly of nobles elected the Chola king
- (C) because a Buddhist council of that name met in the Deccan
- (D) because it is known largely through anthologies of early Tamil poetry called the Sangam works

21. A reader who expects Sangam poems to be mostly about Vedic sacrificial rules would be surprised to find that they instead celebrate:

- (A) the detailed procedures of the ashvamedha sacrifice
- (B) the lives and titles of the Kushana emperors
- (C) love, heroism and generosity
- (D) the customs duties charged along the Silk Route

22. Archaeologists keep unearthing hoards of Roman gold coins along the Tamil coast. The best explanation is that the southern kingdoms:

- (A) were conquered and taxed by the Roman Empire
- (B) struck their own coins inside Roman mints
- (C) traded by sea with the Roman world, which paid in gold for their goods
- (D) sent their kings to be crowned at Rome

23. Which region-and-power pairing for this age is correct?

- (A) the Deccan — the Cholas
- (B) Kalinga — the Cheras
- (C) the northwest frontier — the Pandyas
- (D) the Tamil far south — the Pandyas

24. The Grand Anicut (Kallanai) on the Kaveri is best classified as:

- (A) a stupa raised over relics of the Buddha
- (B) a coastal fort built to block Roman ships
- (C) an ancient dam that spread the river's water across the delta
- (D) a Greek-style free-standing victory pillar

25. Given the Tamil roots of the word, an 'anicut' is most precisely:

- (A) a counted calendar era beginning from a fixed event
- (B) a low dam that raises river water so it can be diverted into canals
- (C) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument with carved railings
- (D) a royal marriage treaty between two dynasties

26. The Grand Anicut mattered to Chola prosperity above all because it:

- (A) watered the Kaveri delta into a rich rice region that fed the kingdom
- (B) served as the dynasty's chief military fortress
- (C) barred Roman ships from reaching Chola ports
- (D) marked the boundary line with the Pandya kingdom

27. The Cheras and Pandyas grew rich chiefly through the same source as their Chola neighbours, namely:

- (A) control of the overland Silk Route through Central Asia
- (B) tribute extracted from the Kushana empire
- (C) sea trade, including commerce with the Roman world
- (D) gold mined in the Central Asian steppe

28. Roman writers' detailed knowledge of pepper and other goods from the Tamil coast is best treated as evidence of:

- (A) a Roman military conquest of the Tamil south
- (B) Roman colonists having founded the southern kingdoms
- (C) active sea trade linking south India with the Mediterranean
- (D) Tamil kings ruling provinces inside Italy

29. Both the Satavahanas and the Tamil kingdoms reached the Roman world, but a careful comparison shows that:

- (A) the Satavahanas reached Rome by land and the Tamils by sea
- (B) the Tamils reached Rome by land and the Satavahanas by sea
- (C) both reached Rome along the overland Silk Route
- (D) both reached Rome chiefly through sea trade rather than overland routes

30. The Indo-Greeks who pushed into the northwest traced their origin to:

- (A) the governors and settlers left in the region in the wake of Alexander
- (B) the Shunga kings of north-central India
- (C) the Chedi rulers of Kalinga
- (D) the Kushana emperors of Central Asia

31. A Greek ambassador named Heliodorus set up a pillar honouring an Indian deity. This single object is most useful for showing that the Indo-Greeks:

- (A) imposed Greek gods on every Indian subject they ruled
- (B) refused all contact with Indian religion
- (C) blended Greek and Indian culture, even adopting Indian beliefs
- (D) demolished Indian shrines wherever they held power

32. Indo-Greek coins are prized by historians mainly because they:

- (A) were never actually circulated in trade
- (B) were all minted within the city of Rome
- (C) carried the Tamil Sangam poems written in Greek letters
- (D) supply most of what we know about these rulers, including their names and portraits

33. That the Indo-Greeks were able to enter and rule parts of India at all is itself best understood as a consequence of:

- (A) an invitation extended to them by the Chola kings
- (B) the weakening of the northwest frontier after the Mauryan breakup
- (C) the Kushanas having built the Silk Route for them
- (D) the launch of the Shaka era calendar

34. Which statement about the foreign rulers in India during this age is most accurate?

- (A) they erased Indian culture and replaced it entirely with their own
- (B) they were largely absorbed into Indian culture, which remained dominant
- (C) they stayed wholly apart and mixed with nothing Indian
- (D) they unified the entire subcontinent under one foreign empire

35. The Shakas who settled in India are also referred to as the:

- (A) Indo-Scythians
- (B) Indo-Greeks
- (C) Indo-Romans
- (D) Indo-Cholas

36. That India's official national calendar today still counts years from the Shaka era is best used as evidence that this age:

- (A) produced nothing that outlived its own time
- (B) was entirely the creation of Roman officials

- (C) left lasting marks on Indian life rather than only ruins
- (D) had no real contact with Indian traditions

37. A 'samvat', the kind of thing the Shaka era is, is best defined as:

- (A) a low dam built across a river to feed canals
- (B) a dome-shaped Buddhist shrine
- (C) a counted era or calendar reckoned from a fixed starting event
- (D) a marriage alliance between two royal houses

38. Among the rulers of this age, the one most closely associated with the Kushanas is:

- (A) Kharavela
- (B) Pushyamitra
- (C) Kanishka
- (D) Gautamiputra

39. The Kushanas' exceptional wealth and importance rested chiefly on their command of:

- (A) the Silk Route linking China to the Mediterranean
- (B) the Grand Anicut dam on the Kaveri
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa's carved railings
- (D) the Sangam poetry academies of the south

40. The 'Silk Route' is most precisely described as:

- (A) a sea lane running directly from the Deccan to Rome
- (B) a network of overland trade routes joining China to the Mediterranean through Central Asia
- (C) a road the Cholas built across the Kaveri delta
- (D) a touring circuit followed by Tamil poets

41. Kanishka's coins, which carry his titles and images of many different gods, are most useful to historians for revealing:

- (A) his royal titles and the diverse deities he honoured
- (B) that he had rejected every form of religion
- (C) that he ruled the Tamil far south
- (D) that he took no part in any trade

42. The Kushanas dominating the Silk Route while the Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms traded by sea together demonstrate that, in this age, India was:

- (A) limited to trade within its own villages
- (B) completely cut off from the outside world
- (C) tied into long-distance trade by both land and sea
- (D) dependent on a single trade route for everything

43. If two sculptures are placed side by side and one shows the Buddha in toga-like robes with wavy hair while the other shows a fuller, rounder figure in spotted red sandstone, the first belongs to the _____ school and the second to the _____ school.

- (A) Mathura; Gandhara
- (B) Gandhara; Mathura
- (C) Sangam; Gandhara
- (D) Mathura; Bharhut

44. Gandhara sculpture is best characterised as:

- (A) an indigenous style carving figures in spotted red sandstone
- (B) a Greco-Buddhist style giving Buddhist subjects Hellenistic forms such as wavy hair and toga-like robes
- (C) a school of Tamil love-and-heroism poetry
- (D) a tradition of dam-and-canal engineering

45. The Mathura school of art is most accurately distinguished by:

- (A) indigenous Indian figures carved in spotted red sandstone with fuller, rounder forms
- (B) Hellenistic robes and wavy Greek-style hair
- (C) poems celebrating love and heroism
- (D) ship designs stamped onto royal coins

46. A textbook lists 'Gandhara: indigenous red sandstone' and 'Mathura: Greek robes and wavy hair'. The corrected version should read:

- (A) Gandhara was Tamil poetry while Mathura was Greek sculpture
- (B) both were purely Greek with no Indian element
- (C) both were styles of Tamil poetry rather than sculpture
- (D) Gandhara fused Greek forms with Buddhist subjects, while Mathura was an indigenous red-sandstone style

47. When the chapter calls Gandhara art an example of 'cultural confluence', it means that the style shows:

- (A) one culture utterly destroying another
- (B) art made with no foreign influence whatsoever
- (C) a complete return to purely Vedic ritual
- (D) different traditions blending into a new shared form while keeping an Indian core

48. Which great works of Sanskrit literature does the chapter associate with this age?

- (A) the Mahabharata and the Ramayana
- (B) the Sangam Tamil anthologies
- (C) the Mauryan-court Arthashastra
- (D) the Hathigumpha inscription

49. Foreign rulers' coins and art in India ended up with 'Indian themes always at the heart'. The best conclusion is that India:

- (A) absorbed and reshaped the newcomers rather than being erased by them
- (B) violently expelled every trace of foreign influence
- (C) was wholly Hellenised and lost its own identity
- (D) stopped all artistic activity during the period

50. The chapter's claim that this was a time of 'remarkable cultural confluence' rests most strongly on examples such as:

- (A) Gandhara art, Kanishka's many-gods coinage, and flourishing Sanskrit texts
- (B) a single uniform style imposed across the whole subcontinent

- (C) the total absence of any foreign element in Indian life
- (D) the disappearance of India's own religions

51. The chapter stresses that without coins and inscriptions we would know far less about this age because:

- (A) no one alive then could read or write at all
- (B) the period left behind no buildings whatsoever
- (C) so much of our evidence for its rulers, trade and religion is physical rather than written chronicles
- (D) every written history of it was a translation from Rome

52. Which list contains ONLY items that serve as physical (material) sources for this age?

- (A) coins, election ballots and newspapers
- (B) emails, photographs and passports
- (C) coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures
- (D) constitutions, voter rolls and tax software

53. Which sequence places these developments in correct order, earliest first?

- (A) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Maurya breakup, then the Satavahanas' rise
- (B) Maurya breakup, then the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's Kushana rule
- (C) the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's rule, then the Maurya breakup
- (D) Kanishka's rule, then the Satavahanas' rise, then the Maurya breakup

54. A student writes, 'The Age of Reorganisation shows that political division and cultural creativity can flourish together.' The best support from the chapter is that:

- (A) the whole subcontinent was peacefully unified under one ruler
- (B) all art and trade ceased until a single empire returned
- (C) the foreign rulers banned every form of Indian culture
- (D) constant rivalry among many kingdoms coincided with new art schools, busy trade and great Sanskrit works

55. A coin shows a king's portrait in Hellenistic style on one face and the name of an Indian god in Indian script on the other. This single object best supports the conclusion that the foreign rulers:

- (A) rejected Indian languages and gods entirely
- (B) ruled the whole subcontinent under a single coinage
- (C) took no interest in trade or money
- (D) merged their own conventions with Indian ones rather than keeping the two apart

56. Assertion: The foreign rulers of this age are usually counted among contributors to Indian civilisation rather than its destroyers. Reason: Indian culture stayed dominant and reshaped much of what the newcomers brought. Which is correct?

- (A) the assertion is true but the reason is false
- (B) the assertion is false though the reason is true

- (C) both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion
- (D) both the assertion and the reason are false

57. Compared with the Mauryan empire that preceded it, the political map of the Age of Reorganisation is best described as:

- (A) an even larger single empire than the Mauryan one
- (B) a single foreign empire covering the whole subcontinent
- (C) empty of any organised states for several centuries
- (D) fragmented into many competing kingdoms instead of one large empire

58. A museum places a Satavahana ship-coin, a hoard of Roman gold from a Tamil port, and a Kushana Silk-Route milestone in one gallery titled 'India and the Wider World'. The single idea the three objects share is that:

- (A) this age connected India to distant lands through both land and sea trade
- (B) India was militarily conquered by Rome and China alike
- (C) India traded only within its own borders in this period
- (D) all of India's foreign contact ran through one single route

59. Which comparison of the Shungas and the Indo-Greeks is accurate for this age?

- (A) both were foreign dynasties descended from Alexander's governors
- (B) the Shungas were an Indian dynasty of the heartland, while the Indo-Greeks were foreigners who entered the weakened northwest
- (C) both were indigenous Tamil powers of the far south
- (D) the Shungas were foreign invaders and the Indo-Greeks were native to the Ganga plain

60. The survival of early Tamil poetry that praises chiefs for their generosity in giving gifts tells a historian most reliably that, in the Sangam-age south:

- (A) rulers were forbidden by law from giving any gifts
- (B) open-handed giving was prized as a mark of a worthy ruler
- (C) wealth was distributed equally and no chiefs existed
- (D) poetry was written only about Vedic sacrifices, not chiefs

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	C	31	C	41	A	51	C
2	D	12	B	22	C	32	D	42	C	52	C
3	B	13	D	23	D	33	B	43	B	53	B
4	A	14	D	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	D
5	B	15	C	25	B	35	A	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	D	26	A	36	C	46	D	56	C
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	D	57	D
8	A	18	D	28	C	38	C	48	A	58	A
9	D	19	C	29	D	39	A	49	A	59	B
10	B	20	D	30	A	40	B	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) 'Reorganisation' fits because political units were constantly broken up and reformed into competing kingdoms, yet this happened alongside vigorous cultural and commercial life — not decline. Saying nothing of value was produced ignores the art schools, coins and Sanskrit works the period left. There was no single empire merely shuffling provinces; the defining feature is plurality of states. And the age was full of warfare, so 'no warfare, peaceful unity' is false.

2. (D) The Mauryan collapse is presented as an internal breakup; foreigners entered the northwest only after that frontier had already weakened. The Kushanas arrived later and never seized the whole heartland in one blow. The Indo-Greeks did not co-rule with the Mauryas — they came after the breakup. And the Satavahanas, a Deccan power, did not topple the Mauryan capital.

3. (B) Because the weakening comes before the invasions in time, the weakening is the cause and the entry of foreigners the effect — a cause must precede its effect. The reverse

claim, that invasions caused the collapse, inverts the sequence. The Mauryas and invaders were distinct peoples, not the same. And the northwest had indeed been Mauryan territory before the breakup.

4. (A) The Shunga dynasty began when the Mauryan commander-in-chief assassinated the last emperor and seized power — an internal coup, not a foreign conquest. There was no election of kings. He did not inherit by marriage, and he led no foreign army; the takeover came from inside the Mauryan establishment.

5. (B) The age combined many rival kingdoms (political competition) with cross-cultural mixing in art, coinage and religion (cultural blending). It was not war-free; competition often meant fighting. It was not a dark age, given Gandhara/Mathura art and Sanskrit works. And many of its kingdoms — the Satavahanas, the Tamil kingdoms, the Shungas — were Indian, not foreign.

6. (A) When a marriage immediately converts enemies into allies, it functions as diplomacy conducted through matrimony — the chapter's point about matrimonial alliances. Treating it as merely private ignores the political effect just described. It is a marriage, not a sacrifice to the gods, and it builds alliance rather than extracting tribute.

7. (A) The ashvamedha let a king proclaim paramountcy: lands the freed horse crossed without challenge were claimed as his. It did not choose a successor, was not a wedding rite, and did not begin a calendar era — that role belongs to a samvat such as the Shaka era.

8. (A) A queen performing the kingship-claiming sacrifice shows women could hold real authority — overturning the idea that only men ruled. It does not show the rite had lost its meaning; she used it precisely because it asserted sovereignty. And her performing a Vedic sacrifice shows the Satavahanas kept, not abandoned, such rituals.

9. (D) The Shungas are remembered for the Vedic revival and patronage of the Bharhut Stupa's carvings. The Grand Anicut was a Chola work on the Kaveri. The Silk Route was the Kushanas' base of wealth. Greek-portrait coins belong to the Indo-Greeks, not the Shungas.

10. (B) The pairing shows religious patronage was not exclusive: a Vedic-reviving house could still support Buddhist art. It does not prove secret conversion, the stupa was genuinely Buddhist (not a relabelled temple), and Buddhism was clearly still alive, since its monuments were being adorned.

11. (B) A stupa is a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, like Bharhut, often ringed by carved railings. A victory pillar (e.g. the Heliodorus pillar) is a different thing. A river-diverting dam is an anicut, and a Tamil poetry anthology is a Sangam collection — none is a stupa.

- 12. (B)** The Shungas held north and central India; the Satavahanas built their power in the Deccan. The Tamil far south belonged to the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas; Kalinga was Kharavela's. The last option reverses the correct regions of the two dynasties.
- 13. (D)** Ship coins point to flourishing sea trade, which fits the Satavahanas' use of Deccan ports. The image is not proof of sea-worship, nor of losing land, nor of a navy against the Kushanas — the Kushanas were a northern land power reached by no Satavahana fleet.
- 14. (D)** A mother-derived royal name plus a land-donating queen mother together show the high standing of royal women. The name is not that of a god, 'Gautami' is a personal/lineage name rather than a city, and being called 'son of Gautami' does not make the king a monk.
- 15. (C)** Such queens are known from inscriptions recording their gifts. They did not campaign against Rome, did not write the Tamil Sangam poetry (a southern tradition), and did not design Gandhara art (a northwestern Greco-Buddhist style).
- 16. (D)** The Satavahanas reached Rome through sea trade via their Deccan ports — hence the ship coins. They had no land border with Rome, did not control the overland Silk Route (that was the Kushanas), and were an independent kingdom, not a Roman province.
- 17. (A)** Kharavela ruled Kalinga and was a committed Jain — hence 'monk-king' though he kept his throne. He did not abdicate to wander, was not a Kushana official in Gandhara, and founded no new religion; he followed the existing Jain faith.
- 18. (D)** Hathigumpha is an inscription — writing cut into rock — and is the chief source for Kharavela, illustrating reliance on inscriptions. Sangam poems are a southern tradition, not about Kalinga; Roman ledgers do not supply his record; and a single inscription, not a coin portrait, is what informs us here.
- 19. (C)** The three crowned kingdoms of the Tamil south were the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas. The Shungas, Satavahanas and Chedis lay to the north and in the Deccan; the Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas were northwestern foreign rulers; and the Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas were northern imperial dynasties.
- 20. (D)** The age is named after the Sangam — collections of early Tamil poetry that are our main window onto it. It is not named for battles, not for a royal-electing assembly, and not for a Buddhist council in the Deccan.
- 21. (C)** Sangam poetry sings chiefly of love, valour and the giving of gifts. It is not a manual of Vedic sacrifice, not a chronicle of the northern Kushana emperors, and not a record of Silk-Route tolls.
- 22. (C)** Roman gold on the Tamil coast reflects sea trade in which Rome bought spices and goods, paying in coin. There is no record of a Roman conquest or taxation of the

south, the Tamils minted at home rather than in Rome, and their kings were not crowned in Rome.

23. (D) The Pandyas were a Tamil far-southern kingdom. The Cholas were also Tamil-southern, not Deccan (the Deccan was Satavahana). Kalinga was Kharavela's, not the Cheras'. And the northwest belonged to foreign rulers, not the Pandyas.

24. (C) The Grand Anicut is a dam built to distribute the Kaveri's water over the delta. It is not a Buddhist stupa, not a fort against Roman ships, and not a Greek victory pillar.

25. (B) An anicut is a low check-dam that lifts river water into irrigation canals. A counted era is a samvat, a dome monument is a stupa, and a marriage treaty is a matrimonial alliance — none is an anicut.

26. (A) By irrigating the delta the anicut created fertile rice land that underpinned Chola wealth. It was not a fortress, did not block ships (it is an inland dam), and was not a boundary marker with the Pandyas.

27. (C) The southern kingdoms prospered through maritime trade, including with Rome — confirmed by Roman coin finds. They did not control the land-based Silk Route (a Kushana asset), took no tribute from the Kushanas, and held no Central Asian mines.

28. (C) Roman familiarity with Tamil-coast goods reflects busy sea trade between south India and the Mediterranean. It does not imply conquest, colonisation by Romans, or Tamil rule in Italy — trade contact, not political control, is what such knowledge shows.

29. (D) The Satavahanas used Deccan ports and the Tamils used southern ports — both relied on the sea. Neither used overland routes to Rome; the Silk Route (land) was the Kushanas' connection to the Mediterranean, not these two powers'.

30. (A) The Indo-Greeks descended from the Greek satraps and settlers who remained after Alexander's campaigns. They were not Shungas (an Indian dynasty), not Chedis of Kalinga, and not the later Kushanas, who were a separate Central Asian people.

31. (C) A Greek envoy dedicating a pillar to an Indian god is a clear sign of cultural blending and even adoption of Indian beliefs. It contradicts the ideas that the Indo-Greeks forced Greek gods on Indians, shunned Indian religion, or destroyed Indian shrines.

32. (D) With few inscriptions surviving, Indo-Greek coins are the chief source for these kings' names and faces. They were genuine trade currency, not Rome-minted, and certainly did not record Tamil Sangam poetry.

33. (B) The Indo-Greeks moved in because the Mauryan collapse had left the northwest frontier weak — the breakup is the cause. No Chola invitation brought them, the Kushanas

did not build the Silk Route to admit them, and the Shaka calendar is unrelated to their entry.

34. (B) The foreign rulers were mostly absorbed, with Indian culture staying dominant — the chapter's central theme. They did not wipe out Indian culture, did not remain wholly separate (Heliodorus and Gandhara art show mixing), and never ruled the whole subcontinent as one empire.

35. (A) The Shakas are also called Indo-Scythians. The Indo-Greeks were a separate people of Alexandrian descent; 'Indo-Romans' is not a ruling group; and 'Indo-Cholas' is not a real term — the Cholas were an indigenous Tamil dynasty.

36. (C) A still-used Shaka-based calendar shows the period left enduring legacies, not just ruins. It therefore contradicts the claims that nothing survived, that Romans created it, or that the age stood apart from Indian traditions — a calendar woven into Indian life proves the opposite.

37. (C) A samvat is a counted calendar era beginning from a fixed point, as with the Shaka era. A river dam is an anicut, a dome shrine is a stupa, and a royal marriage is a matrimonial alliance — none of these is a samvat.

38. (C) Kanishka is the famous Kushana ruler. Kharavela ruled Kalinga, Pushyamitra founded the Shungas, and Gautamiputra was a Satavahana — none of them Kushana.

39. (A) The Kushanas grew rich by controlling the overland Silk Route between China and the Mediterranean. The Grand Anicut was a Chola irrigation work, the Bharhut railings were Shunga-era Buddhist art, and the Sangam academies were a Tamil literary tradition — none was a Kushana source of wealth.

40. (B) The Silk Route was a web of land routes across Central Asia linking China and the Mediterranean. It was not a Deccan-to-Rome sea lane (that was Satavahana sea trade), not a Chola delta road, and not a poets' circuit.

41. (A) Coins showing his titles and a variety of gods reveal Kanishka's styling and the many faiths he patronised. They do not show rejection of religion (the many gods prove the opposite), do not place him in the Tamil south, and do not suggest he avoided trade — coinage itself implies commerce.

42. (C) Land trade via the Silk Route plus sea trade from Deccan and southern ports together show India linked outward by both land and sea. This refutes the ideas that trade was only village-level, that India was isolated, or that it relied on one route alone.

43. (B) Greek-style robes and wavy hair mark the Greco-Buddhist Gandhara school; fuller figures in spotted red sandstone mark the indigenous Mathura school. Reversing them is

the classic trap. 'Sangam' is Tamil poetry, not sculpture, and 'Bharhut' names a stupa site, not the red-sandstone school — which is Mathura.

44. (B) Gandhara art fuses Greek (Hellenistic) form with Buddhist subjects. The red-sandstone indigenous style is Mathura, Tamil poetry is the Sangam tradition, and dam engineering describes the anicut — none of these is Gandhara.

45. (A) Mathura art is the indigenous red-sandstone school with fuller forms. Hellenistic robes and wavy hair belong to Gandhara, love-and-heroism poems are Sangam works, and ship-stamped coins are Satavahana — none describes Mathura.

46. (D) The textbook has swapped the two: Gandhara is the Greco-Buddhist style and Mathura the indigenous red-sandstone style. Neither is Tamil poetry, Mathura is not purely Greek (it is indigenous), and both are sculpture, not poetry.

47. (D) Cultural confluence means traditions merge into a shared style without the local character being erased — Gandhara blends Greek form with Indian Buddhist content. It is not the destruction of one culture, not influence-free art (it is plainly Hellenistic-influenced), and not a Vedic revival.

48. (A) The chapter links the period to the great Sanskrit epics, the Mahabharata and the Ramayana. The Sangam anthologies are Tamil, not Sanskrit; the Arthashastra belongs to the earlier Mauryan court; and Hathigumpha is an inscription, not a literary epic.

49. (A) Indian themes at the core of foreign rulers' coins and art show India absorbed and transformed the newcomers. It did not expel them by force (their objects survive and were patronised), was not fully Hellenised (Indian themes remained central), and clearly did not halt art — the art is the very evidence.

50. (A) Confluence is shown by blended Gandhara art, Kanishka's multi-deity coins and thriving Sanskrit literature. It is not shown by one imposed uniform style, by the absence of foreign elements (confluence requires them), or by religions vanishing — the period's religions remained vigorous.

51. (C) Coins and inscriptions are physical sources that carry much of what we know, since continuous written chronicles are scarce. People could read and write (inscriptions prove it), buildings like stupas do survive, and the histories were not Roman translations — the point is the reliance on material evidence.

52. (C) Coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures are genuine material remains from the period. Election ballots, newspapers, emails, photographs, passports, constitutions, voter rolls and tax software are all modern items that did not exist then and cannot be physical sources for it.

53. (B) The Mauryan breakup came first; the Satavahanas rose in the post-Mauryan Deccan; Kanishka's Kushana power came later still. The other orderings wrongly place Kanishka or the Satavahanas before the Mauryan breakup, which contradicts the chapter's chronology.

54. (D) The thesis is supported by many rival kingdoms existing alongside flourishing Gandhara/Mathura art, lively trade and the Sanskrit epics — division and creativity together. A peaceful single empire would remove the 'division' the student is arguing for; art and trade did not cease; and foreign rulers did not ban Indian culture — they were absorbed by it.

55. (D) A coin combining a Greek-style portrait with an Indian deity in Indian script shows the foreign rulers blended their conventions with Indian ones. It refutes the idea that they rejected Indian language and gods, does not imply a single subcontinental empire, and a coin itself shows engagement with trade, not indifference to it.

56. (C) The foreign rulers are indeed treated as contributors because Indian culture remained dominant and absorbed what they brought — so both statements are true and the reason explains the assertion. The reason is not false (absorption is the chapter's theme), and the assertion is not false (they were largely integrated, not erasers), so the partial and wholly-false options fail.

57. (D) Where the Mauryas formed one large empire, the following age splintered into many rival kingdoms — the heart of 'reorganisation'. It was not a still-larger empire, not one foreign empire over all India, and certainly not stateless — the chapter is full of named kingdoms.

58. (A) A sea-trade ship coin, Roman gold from sea commerce and a Silk-Route (land) marker together show India linked to distant lands by sea and land. They do not show conquest by Rome or China, contradict purely internal trade, and disprove reliance on a single route — two different routes are represented.

59. (B) The Shungas were an indigenous dynasty of north-central India; the Indo-Greeks were foreigners of Alexandrian descent who moved into the northwest after the Mauryan breakup. They were not both Greek-descended foreigners, not Tamil southern powers, and the labels are not reversed — the Shungas were native, the Indo-Greeks foreign.

60. (B) Poems celebrating chiefs for generosity show that liberal gift-giving was a valued royal virtue in the Tamil south. The poems would make no sense if giving were forbidden, they presuppose chiefs and unequal wealth rather than equality, and Sangam verse sings of love, valour and generosity — not Vedic sacrifice.